

# Umrah in Q1 2026: The Scale

Umrah performers in Q1 2026, from the GASTAT quarterly release. Internal performers were already inside Saudi Arabia; external performers arrived from abroad.

Total Umrah Performers

15M

Internal (inside Saudi)

9M

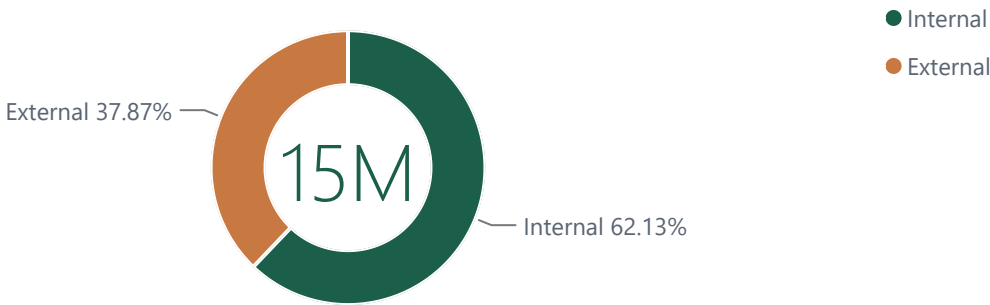
External (from abroad)

6M

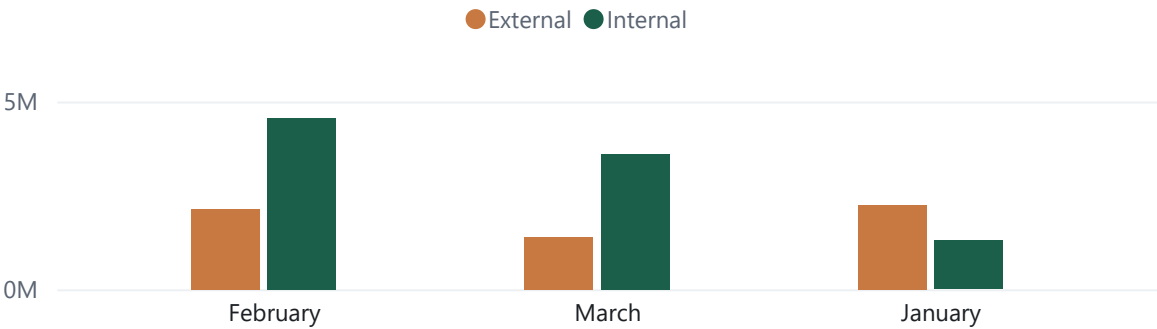
Share Arriving From Abroad

37.9%

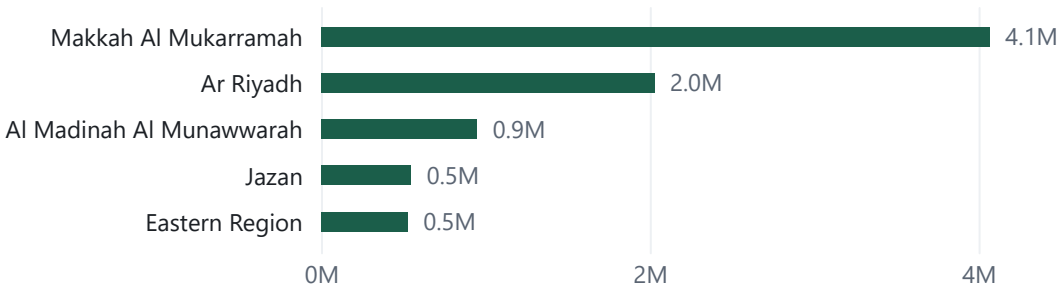
Internal vs External



Performers by Month



Internal Performers by Saudi Region



Region Detail

| Region                   | Internal Performers | Female Share % |
|--------------------------|---------------------|----------------|
| Makkah Al Mukarramah     | 4,066,669           | 33.5%          |
| Ar Riyadh                | 2,026,029           | 33.0%          |
| Al Madinah Al Munawwarah | 948,687             | 33.1%          |
| Jazan                    | 545,899             | 39.2%          |
| Total                    | 9,464,496           | 40.6%          |

# Who Comes From Abroad

The 5.77 million who arrived from abroad, broken down by gender, age group and month.

## External Performers

6M

## Female Share of Arrivals

51.8%

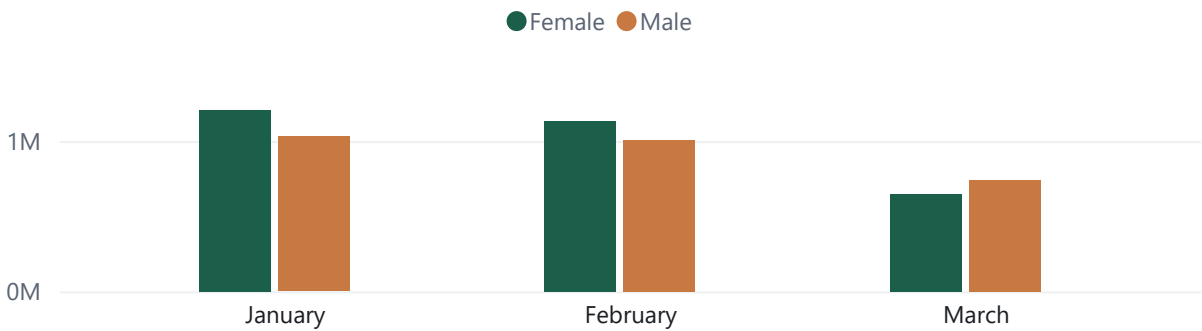
## Madinah External Visitors

4M

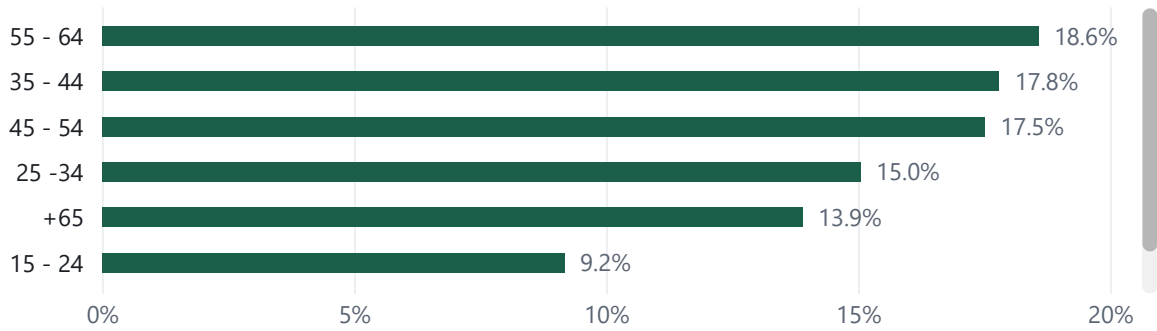
## Arriving by Air

86.0%

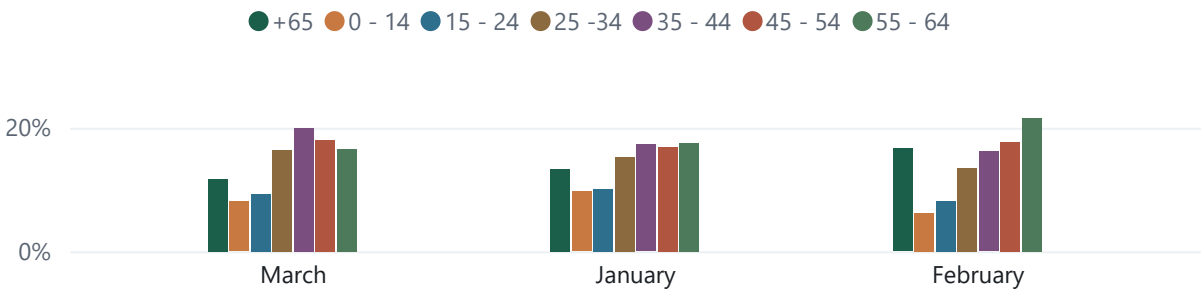
## External Arrivals by Month and Gender



## Age Mix of External Performers



## Age Mix by Month

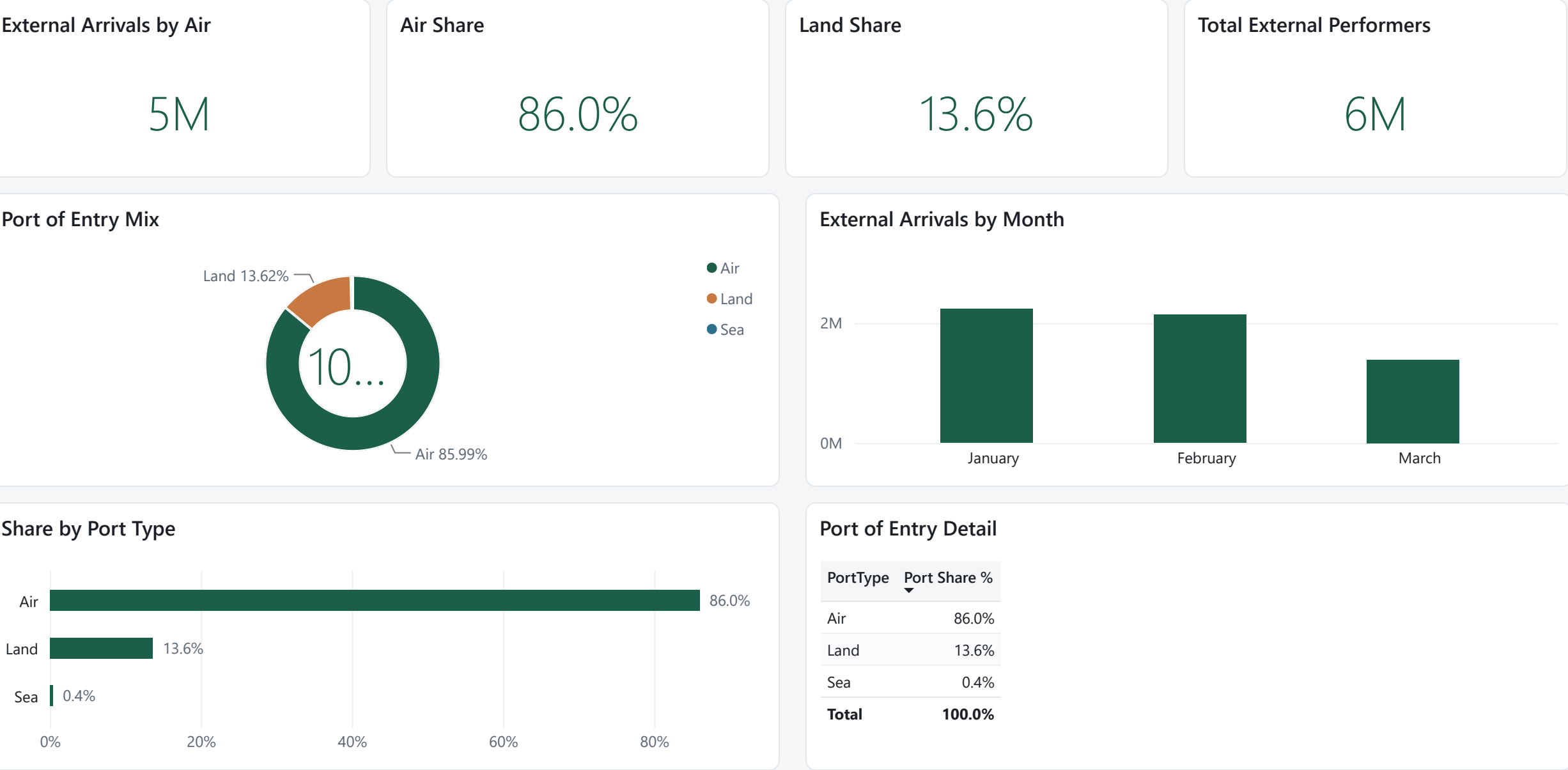


## Age Group Detail

| AgeGroup | External Age Share % |
|----------|----------------------|
| 55 - 64  | 18.6%                |
| 35 - 44  | 17.8%                |
| 45 - 54  | 17.5%                |
| 25 - 34  | 15.0%                |
| Total    | 100.0%               |

# How They Arrive

Port of entry mix. The air share is the connectivity moment: a traveller who lands needs data before they leave the terminal.



# The Ramadan Effect

Ramadan 2026 began 17 February. Internal performers surged while arrivals from abroad fell. The two move in opposite directions.

## Internal Performers

9M

## External Performers

6M

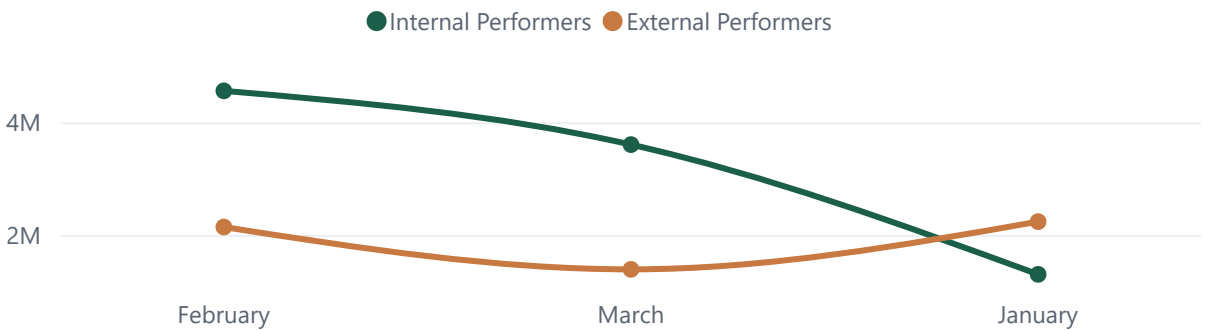
## Internal MoM Growth

107.6%

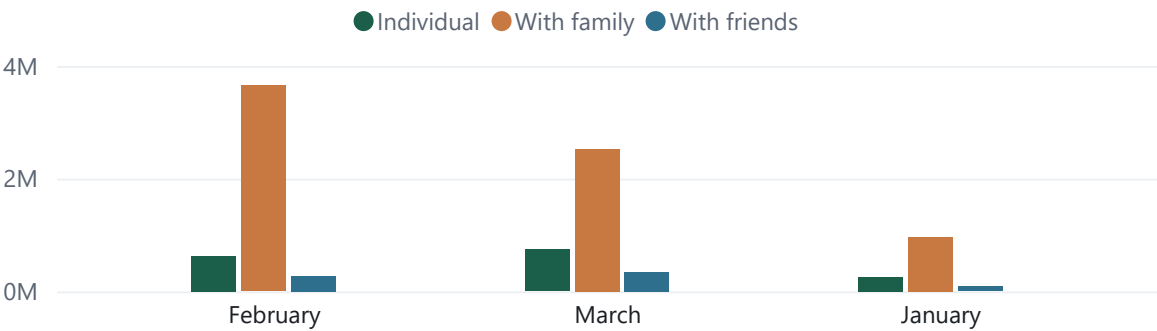
## External MoM Growth

169.4%

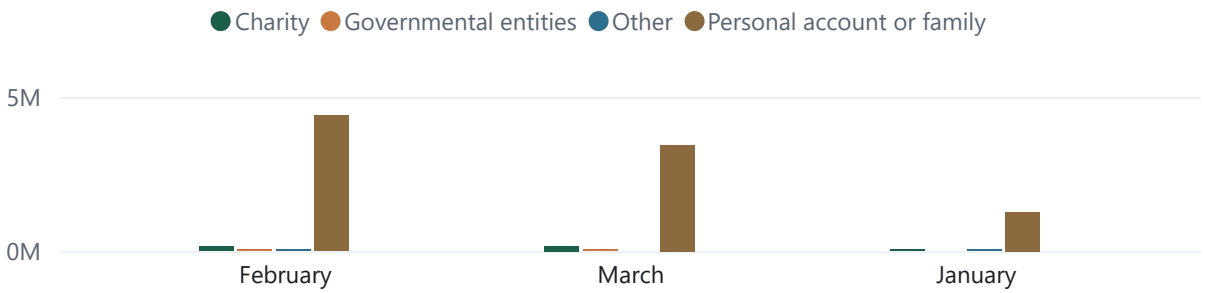
## The Divergence: Internal Rises, External Falls



## Trip Type by Month



## Who Pays, by Month



## Monthly Summary

| Month    | Internal Performers | External Performers | MoM Growth % |
|----------|---------------------|---------------------|--------------|
| February | 4,558,570           | 2,141,723           | 89.3%        |
| March    | 3,604,583           | 1,390,130           | -25.5%       |
| January  | 1,301,343           | 2,237,418           |              |
| Total    | 9,464,496           | 5,769,271           | 127.4%       |

# The Nigeria Gap

What this dataset cannot tell you, and the honest range to plan with instead.

How many Nigerians perform Umrah each year? **No public source answers this at usable granularity.**

Every figure on this page is an estimate, shown as a band with its method attached. None of it is measured data, and none of it comes from GASTAT.

## GASTAT (Saudi official statistics)

Publishes external Umrah performers by gender, age group and port of entry only.

**Country of origin: not published.**

So the 5.77m arrivals on the previous pages cannot be split to Nigeria.

## NAHCON (Nigeria)

Licenses and regulates Nigerian Umrah operators. The public register lists about 239 companies with a current licence.

**Pilgrim volume: not published.**

Operator count only. No manifests, no package sales.

## IATA 2023 origin-to-destination

Nigeria to Jeddah 92,100. Nigeria to Madinah 45,500. All trip purposes, one year.

**Partial signal.**

Air trips to the Hejaz, not Umrah-specific. The closest hard anchor available.

Recommended planning range

**80,000 to 150,000** Nigerian Umrah air travellers per year. Central planning figure about 110,000.

Method: two independent estimates that agree. (A) 2023 air-route residual, Jeddah plus Madinah air departures less the Hajj airlift, times an assumed Umrah share. (B) operator-base scaling across the 239 licensed companies. Treat as an assumption, never as measured data.

## Three ways to close the gap for real

1. Freedom of Information request to NAHCON for operator returns or an aggregate licensed-operator pilgrim count. NAHCON regulates the 239 operators and can require manifests.
2. Survey a stratified sample of the 239 licensed operators, the top 20 by size plus about 30 drawn from the long tail, then gross up.
3. Buy airline seat-capacity and bookings data for Lagos, Kano and Abuja to Jeddah and Madinah by month, and apply an Umrah share.

Seasonality to carry into any model: demand concentrates in the 8 to 10 weeks around Ramadan, which moves about 11 days earlier each year.